cite an example for this, a Canada-based, Indian-origin poet and influencer with millions of followers who writes on issues of body image and female sexuality hosted an Instagram Live session with a journalist, Rana Ayyub, a serial critic of the prime minister who had also been making recent appearances on several international media outlets with a single agenda to paint the Modi government as Islamophobic and incompetent.[29] On further investigation by the New Delhi Police, revelations appeared that this poet regularly upholds and defends the activities of an organization called the Poetic Justice Foundation[30], a pro-Khalistan outfit, which played an active role in putting together the toolkit posted by Thunberg.[31]

It later came to light that Rihanna was paid $2.5 million by a public relations firm, Skyrocket. Greta Thunberg is one of the directors of Skyrocket, which also appears to have direct links to Poetic Justice Foundation.[32]

Twitter became overactive with influencers who pushed the same narrative on a daily basis, many of them new employees of the five lakh social media warriors newly hired by the Congress.[33] In a few months, the narrative, instigated regularly by leaders of the opposition parties, became so banal that citizens began to see through the agenda and stopped responding to the paid-for stories. As it no longer tugged at people's heartstrings, the Opposition lost interest and slowly let the issue subside, by beginning to use this network on a new issue.

The most damage that this episode did was that it possibly took India back several steps in its fight against the virus. As mentioned earlier in the book, case curves in Punjab and Haryana had begun to plateau and halt their downward trajectory. Samples from these states which were sent for genome sequencing revealed that 20 per cent of all samples cases were from the Alpha variant of the virus which had pushed several countries like the UK and Spain into the grip of a deadly second wave of COVID-19 infections.[34] Painfully, after a slew of such undesirable events, 10 months later in November 2021, the prime minister announced that in the interest of the nation, he would initiate parliamentary proceedings to repeal the farm laws since his government wasn't able to on-board all sections of the farming community. He added that he still believed in the reformative power of the laws but he would work with all groups to find an agreeable piece of legislation, in the hope of ending the protests.[35]